

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

Alas, capitalism. The wellness industry is dripping in wealth privilege, and it's more convenient for brands to feign ignorance about the important role that money plays than to acknowledge and consider solutions for it. After all, are they not in it for . . . the money? It is very inconvenient for many businesses to acknowledge the fact that real self-care is not for sale. Somewhere in our busy lives we have lost the art of looking after ourselves, and tried to replace it with a scented candle and some CBD oil. That'll be £79, please.

At its very essence, self-care is found in the habits and rituals that we use to make sure that we are fulfilling those needs in Maslow's hierarchy, and a key element of that is to have a peaceful and purposeful relationship with money. So, financial wellbeing must be a consideration in how we look after ourselves, because when we lose control of that element of our lives, no amount of superficial grooming can make us feel okay.

Why is it so hard to talk about money – and why is it vital that we do?

It is not news to anybody that it's difficult to have an honest conversation about money. For everything that we are willing to admit to, there are a thousand things that go unsaid, because we are embarrassed or ashamed, or we don't think that people will understand. Internal shame is often mirrored by external judgement, whether directly or by proxy of a sensationalized